

Point-of-sale review

Four months of transaction data from RetailPOS_DB, read for what it says about where the business is going — and for what the system is and isn't recording.

\$237,720	17,718	127	842
TOTAL SALES	TRANSACTIONS	TRADING DAYS	PRODUCTS SOLD

Executive summary

Sales look flat. They are not flat — they are two significant, opposing movements that happen to cancel. Everything else in this report follows from that.

The finding that matters

Total sales trend **+1.1% across the window at $p = 0.91$** — statistically no trend at all. Underneath, **customer visits rose 14.6%** ($p = 0.015$) while **the average basket fell 11.5%** ($p = 0.045$). Both clear significance; the total does not, because they very nearly cancel. More people are coming in and each is spending less. **Traffic is not the constraint — what happens at the counter is.**

Six things worth acting on

FINDING	DETAIL	SIZE
Basket is shrinking	The only significant negative in the data, cancelling real growth in footfall.	-11.5%
Lottery earns almost nothing	40% of the sales line; nearly all remitted to OLG. Commission is the real income.	≈\$7,584
Lottery customers buy nothing else	7,491 visits — 42% of all transactions — bought a ticket and left.	15.7% attach
Void rate is very high	1,970 voided bills, 98.5% with no reason recorded.	11.1% of bills
Nothing is traceable to a person	One shared POS login across every sale, void and drawer open.	1 account
Profit cannot be calculated	Cost price present on 102 of 842 products sold.	6.8% of revenue

One limitation that shapes every conclusion

The window runs mid-April to mid-August — straight into summer. Four months cannot separate a growth trend from a seasonal one. Where a category's rise would be explained by warm weather, this report marks it *unproven* rather than reporting it as growth. Re-running this against a backup covering autumn would settle it.

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Data, repairs and method

What was analysed, what had to be fixed first, and how the statistics were run.

The source

A SQL Server full backup of `RetailPOS_DB` taken 19 August 2026 on `DESKTOP-VDRD582\SQLEXPRESS`. Despite the `.bak` extension being described as MySQL, it is a Microsoft SQL Server backup (MTF container, engine version 10, compatibility level 100). It was restored on SQL Server 2022 and queried directly. Figures come from `InvoiceInfo`, `Invoice_Product` and `Invoice_Payment`.

A repair was required before any cash figure could be trusted

Three invoices carried mis-keyed *cash tendered* amounts, the worst being **\$804,906,004,014.00** against a **\$20.00** sale. Together they pushed reported cash to \$886.9 billion and made every payment report meaningless.

INVOICE	CASH ENTERED	ACTUAL SALE	DATE
13424	\$804,906,004,014.00	\$20.00	21 Jul 2026
6795	\$82,000,796,855.00	\$10.26	5 Jun 2026
17	\$5,660,300.00	\$30.51	15 Apr 2026

The error sat only in the tender field. `GrandTotal` was correct on all three, so sales figures were never affected — only cash reporting. Tendered has been set equal to the sale amount, and reported cash falls from \$886.9 billion to **\$170,730.74**. The repair script selects rows by rule rather than by hardcoded ID, runs inside a transaction with a post-check, and is safe to re-run.

How trends were fitted

Ordinary least squares on **whole Sunday–Saturday weeks only**. The extract begins on a Wednesday and ends on a Wednesday; including those part-weeks would read as a collapse at both ends. Seventeen whole weeks qualify. Every trend is reported with R^2 and a two-sided p-value, and "significant" means $p < 0.05$.

Seventeen weeks is enough to detect a strong trend and not enough to detect a weak one. A **"not significant" result here means *not proven*, not *proven flat***.

Three independent totals agree

BASIS	TOTAL	NOTE
Invoice headers (<code>GrandTotal</code>)	\$237,425.99	The figure used throughout
Tender less change given	\$237,456.76	+0.01%
Line items summed	\$237,659.70	+0.10%

The spread is invoice-level discounts and round-off. Agreement to within 0.1% across three independent paths means the data is internally consistent.

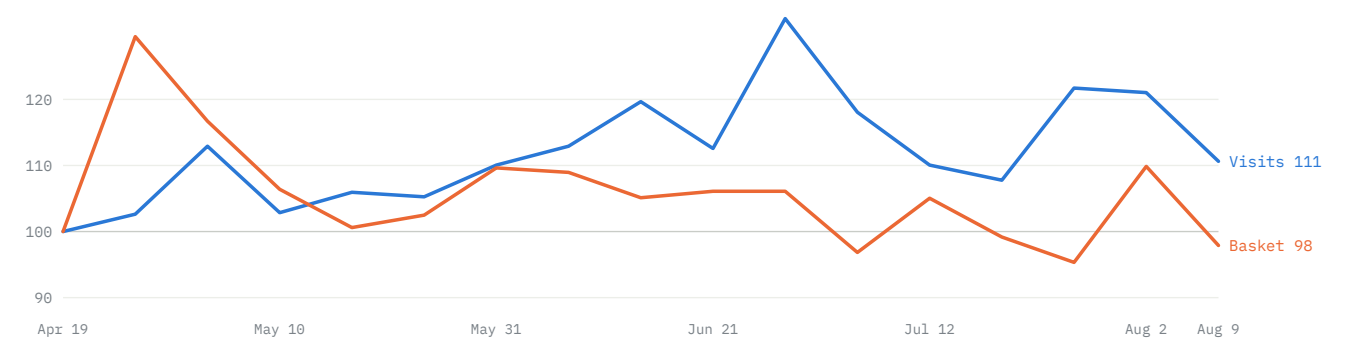
No customer or cardholder data exists in this database

InvoiceInfo declares columns for card and customer detail — CardNo , CardHolder , ApprovalCode , CardType , CustID , EmailID , AddressX — and every one is empty on all 17,718 rows. Card processing runs through Clover, so nothing lands in them. Every figure in this report is an aggregate.

Is the trend positive?

Fitted on 17 whole weeks, 19 April to 15 August 2026.

MEASURE	CHANGE	R ²	P	VERDICT
Total sales	+1.1%	0.001	0.909	NOT SIGNIFICANT
Customer visits	+14.6%	0.337	0.015	SIGNIFICANT
Average basket	-11.5%	0.242	0.045	SIGNIFICANT
Retail only	+15.9%	0.190	0.080	NOT SIGNIFICANT
Lottery net	-18.0%	0.084	0.260	NOT SIGNIFICANT



Visits and average basket, both indexed to 100 at the first whole week. The widening gap is the whole story: footfall climbing, spend per visit falling.

The store is running to stand still. A second, weaker signal points the same way: retail is up 15.9% while lottery is down 18.0% — a shift toward the side of the shop that actually earns a margin — though neither clears significance on its own.

What this means practically

Spending effort on driving footfall would be spending it on the thing that is already working. The constraint is conversion and basket size at the counter. The clearest single opportunity is in section 05: **7,491 visits bought a lottery ticket and nothing else.**

Category performance

Weekly revenue by category, first half of the window against the second.

CATEGORY	REVENUE	CHANGE	P	VERDICT
Lottery	\$95,109	-8.8%	0.260	NOT SIGNIFICANT
Tobacco	\$48,472	+1.3%	0.922	FLAT
Beer	\$39,221	+17.2%	0.076	NOT SIGNIFICANT
Grocery (no tax)	\$12,128	+33.7%	0.017	SIGNIFICANT
Drinks	\$12,084	+49.5%	<0.001	SIGNIFICANT
Alcohol	\$3,852	+26.9%	0.158	NOT SIGNIFICANT
General items	\$2,677	+3.4%	0.578	FLAT
Ready-to-drink	\$2,527	+246.1%	<0.001	SIGNIFICANT

Read the drinks growth with care

Drinks, ready-to-drink and beer are the three categories summer inflates, and they rise over exactly the stretch that runs into summer. Four months cannot tell growth from season. Expanding facings now is reasonable; treating the growth as permanent is not. **Book the decision for review in October.**

The more reliable signal is tobacco

Tobacco is flat in dollars (+1.3%) and has given up **2.35 points of retail share** — from 35.4% to 33.0% — while the shop around it grew. It remains the largest retail category, so this is not urgent, but in a nationally declining category the share number is the one to track, and it argues for planning the replacement of that shelf space rather than defending it.

Share of retail, first half against second

CATEGORY	FIRST HALF	SECOND HALF	DRIFT
Tobacco	35.4%	33.0%	-2.35pp
Drinks	7.2%	9.5%	+2.34pp
Beer	26.7%	28.5%	+1.84pp
Ready-to-drink	0.8%	2.6%	+1.71pp
Grocery (no tax)	7.7%	8.9%	+1.18pp

Lottery

Counted inside sales, as the store books it, and separated here because it behaves nothing like the rest of the shop.

\$151,681

TICKET SALES

Face value taken across the counter.

\$56,572

PRIZES PAID

37.3% paid back out.

\$95,109

NET HELD

Owed to OLG, not earned.

≈\$7,584

EST. COMMISSION

At 5% — confirm on statements.

Lottery is a commission business, not a revenue one

The \$95,109 held is not income; nearly all of it is remitted to OLG. At a 5% retailer rate the store earns roughly **\$7,584** on \$151,681 of tickets. So lottery contributes about **5% of what the business actually takes in**, while occupying **40% of the sales line** and **50% of all counter time**. The commission rate used here is indicative — check it against your OLG statements before relying on the figure.

The largest single opportunity in this data

BASKET TYPE	TRANSACTIONS	SHARE OF ALL	AVG RETAIL BASKET
Lottery only — bought no goods	7,491	42.3%	—
Lottery and goods	1,400	7.9%	\$16.11
Goods only	8,827	49.8%	\$13.60

Only 15.7% of lottery customers buy anything else

7,491 visits — 42% of every transaction in four months — bought a ticket and nothing more. The ones who do add goods spend **\$16.11**, *more* than the \$13.60 of a customer who never touches lottery. **This is not a low-value crowd; it is an unserved one.** Converting one in twenty at the ordinary basket would add roughly **\$5,100** over a comparable period. The queue is already there, and it is currently worth far less per minute than the rest of the shop.

Trading rhythm

When the store actually makes money — the basis for staffing decisions.

	9a	10a	11a	12p	1p	2p	3p	4p	5p	6p	7p	8p	9p	10p
Sun		1069	1561	1700	1894	1314	1529	1340	1715	1479	1466	1213	1029	1135
Mon	676	768	1064	1682	1568	1469	1502	1568	2083	1710	1293	1012	1223	837
Tue	908	975	1245	1749	1616	1685	1701	1721	1764	1997	1704	1300	1457	996
Wed	909	989	1390	1975	1950	1387	1488	1761	2033	2019	1613	1332	1314	909
Thu	740	826	1135	1431	1710	1439	1520	1547	2084	1836	1508	1033	1184	935
Fri	959	876	1378	1893	2129	1421	1222	1935	2049	2238	2218	2114	1356	1354
Sat	818	946	1647	1152	1828	1212	1862	1685	1655	2068	2058	1249	1234	1367

Retail revenue by hour and weekday across the whole period. Darker is more money through the till. Peak is Friday at 6pm.

By weekday

DAY	SALES PER TRADING DAY	RETAIL	LOTTERY
Friday	\$2,339	\$1,288	\$1,051
Saturday	\$2,077	\$1,160	\$918
Tuesday	\$1,919	\$1,160	\$760
Wednesday	\$1,819	\$1,116	\$703
Thursday	\$1,679	\$1,055	\$623
Monday	\$1,644	\$1,027	\$617
Sunday	\$1,628	\$1,055	\$573

The pattern is consistent week to week, which makes cover a planning decision rather than a guess. Friday and Saturday evenings carry roughly 40% more than a Monday.

Late trade is the growth story within beer

Beer sold from 9pm onward rose from **8.8% to 18.1%** of beer revenue across the window (+0.36 points per week, $p = 0.030$). In dollars the gap is starker: **late beer grew 89%** ($p = 0.002$) against +31% for beer overall. The late trade is taking share within a growing category.

Average unit price falls from **\$7.39 before 9pm to \$5.88 after** — the late trade buys singles, not packs. That is a well-defined place to test a multi-buy offer on 473ml cans, and it speaks directly to the shrinking-basket problem in section 03.

Voids and cash control

The largest control weakness found, and it is not about any individual.

1,970 VOIDED BILLS 11.1% of all transactions.	\$43,394 VOIDED VALUE 18.3% of gross.	98.5% NO REASON GIVEN 1,940 of 1,970 blank.	1,742 NO-SALE DRAWER OPENS Recorded in the POS log.
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A void rate above 11% of transactions is very high for convenience retail, and with no reason recorded on 98.5% of them, nothing is auditable after the fact. **The largest single void is \$5,600** — against a largest-ever completed sale of \$450. The top 20 voids alone account for 35% of all voided value.

The POS cannot attribute any of this to a person

Every attribution field holds a single shared value: `InvoiceInfo.UID` is "admin" on all 17,718 sales, `Logs.UserID` is "admin" on all 28,308 log entries, and `DeletedInvoices.Operator` is only ever "User" or "admin". Nothing distinguishes one member of staff from another.

Correlating voids with the StoreOps shift roster

Matching each void to whoever held the till at that moment is the only route available. It attributes 68% of voids (the rest fall before StoreOps records begin), and till sessions never overlap, so where a session exists the match is unambiguous. It still says *who was on shift*, never *who pressed void*.

STAFF	ROLE	SALES	VOIDS	VOID RATE	VALUE VOIDED	% OF THEIR \$
Ashin	admin	933	167	17.90%	\$2,823	20.5%
Jaigy	payroll admin	461	69	14.97%	\$1,039	16.2%
Abijith	employee	5,435	575	10.58%	\$11,992	17.1%
Blesson	manager	5,581	519	9.30%	\$12,803	17.5%

This does not point at anyone

The differences are beyond chance (χ^2 , $p = 2.8 \times 10^{-15}$), but the highest rate on the list belongs to the owner, and the two highest belong to the two admin accounts with by far the smallest samples — consistent with void rate tracking *corrections and admin work* rather than misconduct. Measured by **value**, everyone sits in a tight 16.2–20.5% band. **The control gap is the finding, not any individual.**

The till-variance feature exists and is switched off

Of the 28 columns in `POS_ClosingCash`, 23 are empty on every row — including the denomination breakdown, `ClosingBalance` and `DifferInCash`. The POS has a complete cash-count and variance function that is not in use. This is precisely the gap StoreOps was built to fill in spreadsheets; turning it on would give a second, independent count to reconcile against.

Catalogue health

What is in the product master, and how little of it matters.

23,567 PRODUCTS ON FILE In the product master.	842 EVER SOLD 3.6% of the catalogue.	2 PRODUCTS = 50% OF REVENUE Both lottery.	34 PRODUCTS = 90% The list that matters.
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22,725 products — 96.4% of the catalogue — have never been scanned once. And the concentration among those that do sell is extreme: two products (LOTTO IN and INSTANT) are half of all revenue, twenty are 80%, thirty-four are 90%.

This makes the cost-price problem small

Cost is missing on 94% of what sells, which sounds like a large project. It is not. **Entering purchase cost on 34 products would enable real margin reporting on 90% of turnover.** That is an hour of work, and it is the single highest-return task available — because margin, not revenue, is what tells you whether beer or tobacco earns its shelf space.

Hygiene

Genuinely clean: every sold product carries a barcode, and no barcode is shared between two products. Two problems do need attention:

- **18 groups of duplicate product names** — the same item entered two or three times as separate records, splitting its sales history. CASH BACK exists twice, Tide three times, Van Dens Earphones three times. Each duplicate makes a product look weaker than it is.
- **Categories drift.** Roughly \$4,624 of beer sits under Drinks and Deli rather than Beer, which understates the beer category by about 12% and inflates the Drinks growth figure in section 04.

Only 49 of 108 defined categories are in use. Drinks holds 146 products for \$12,084 — \$83 per product — against Tobacco's 90 products for \$48,472, or \$539 each. Drinks is where the clutter lives.

Case study: Electronics — My Top Gift

A 46-product phone-accessory range loaded on 19 June 2026. A useful worked example of how to judge a range.

\$578.30

REVENUE

61 days on shelf.

26

UNITS SOLD

0.43 a day.

16 / 46

SKUS THAT SOLD

30 have never sold.

\$786.70

DEAD STOCK AT RETAIL

72% of range value.

What sells

PRODUCT	SHELF PRICE	UNITS	REVENUE
Ven Dens Power Bank	\$34.99	3	\$118.62
Van Dens Earphones	\$15.99	6	\$101.64
Ven Dens Adapter	\$17.99–20.99	4	\$91.49
Borofone Headphones	\$49.99	1	\$56.49
Hoco Charger	\$15.99	2	\$36.14

What doesn't — and the pattern is clear

Everything above roughly \$25 is dead, with the single exception of the power bank and one headphone sale. Stuck items include a **\$60.99 Hoco BT speaker**, a **\$51.99 headset**, **two \$49.99 Borofone headphones** and a **\$49.99 Hoco hair clipper** — five items holding \$263 of retail value with zero movement in two months. The hair clipper is not a phone accessory at all.

The range is also duplicated: 13 of the 30 dead items are cables, chargers or car holders that already have a selling twin at a different price. **Ven dens cable** appears three times at \$12.99, none sold.

The category does earn its place — at a narrower width

14 of the 23 bills containing a gift item (61%) also contained other shopping, worth \$483.60 in total bill value. These items pull incremental spend rather than standing alone. Keep the sub-\$20 earphones, cables and chargers plus the \$34.99 power bank; clear the high-ticket tail and merge the duplicate SKUs.

Purchase cost is \$0.00 on all 46 items, so margin and the true cost of the dead stock cannot be calculated from this data.

Recommendations

Ordered by return on effort.

1 Enter cost price on the top 34 products

An hour of work that unlocks margin reporting on 90% of turnover. Everything else in this report is revenue and volume; only margin tells you what is worth the shelf. This is the highest-return single task available.

2 Give every staff member their own POS login

Costs nothing and turns every question about voids, discounts and drawer opens from circumstantial into definitive. Without it, no loss-prevention question can be answered properly.

3 Work the lottery queue

7,491 visits bought a ticket and nothing else, and lottery customers who do add goods spend more than everyone else. Put impulse lines where the lottery queue actually stands. Converting one in twenty is worth roughly \$5,100 per four months.

4 Make the void reason mandatory, and require a manager code above \$50

98.5% of voids carry no reason. A threshold approval would have caught the \$5,600 void. Also add a till-side sanity check rejecting any tender more than \$500 above the sale total, which prevents a repeat of the mis-keyed cash entries.

5 Treat the shrinking basket as the problem to solve

It is the only significant negative in the data and it is cancelling genuine growth in footfall. Start with the \$2–\$10 band and the 9pm–11pm singles trade, where one added item changes the basket materially.

6 Clean the catalogue

Merge the 18 duplicate product groups, move the misfiled beer out of Drinks and Deli, and archive — not delete — the 22,725 items that have never sold, so lookups and future analysis stop carrying 96% noise.

7 Turn on the POS till-variance feature

It already exists and is switched off. It would give a second independent cash count to reconcile against StoreOps, which is exactly what you want for cash control.

8 Re-run this analysis after autumn

The drinks, RTD and beer growth cannot be separated from summer on four months of data. A backup covering September to November would settle which of them is real, and would make the trend figures in section 03 considerably more reliable.